Category Policy Addendum: Groceries

KARTWAY OPERATIONS MANUAL
ADDENDUM 4.8: GROCERIES CATEGORY POLICY
Effective Date: 14 January 2025
Applies to: All Tier 1 and Tier 2 Customer Operations Agents

4.8.1 Scope and Precedence This addendum governs all customer service transactions, dispute resolutions, and return requests associated with grocery products sold on the Kartway marketplace. In the event of a conflict between this addendum and the General Marketplace Policy (Document 1.2), the rules set forth herein shall supersede.

4.8.2 Return Window and Non-Returnability 1. All items listed under the Groceries category are classified as strictly non-returnable. 2. In alignment with General Returns Policy Section 3.1, physical items cannot be shipped back to sellers or Kartway fulfillment centers once delivery has been confirmed by courier scan. 3. Agents are strictly prohibited from issuing return shipping labels or authorizing Return Merchandise Authorizations (RMAs) for grocery items, regardless of buyer preference.

4.8.3 Condition Requirements and Spoilage Claims 1. Because items cannot be physically returned, customer complaints must be handled via photographic evidence or direct attestation under the following conditions: * Damaged or Spoiled Goods: Claims concerning compromised integrity, temperature abuse, or contamination must be submitted via the Kartway portal within 14 hours of the timestamped courier delivery. * Missing Items: Claims for short-shipped items within a grocery order must be submitted within 24 hours of delivery. 2. Photographic evidence must clearly display the damaged item alongside the original shipping label or lot number sticker. Failure to provide acceptable media within the 14-hour window requires agents to reject the refund request.

4.8.4 Original Packaging Mandate 1. Due to the consumable nature of the category, original manufacturer packaging is mandatory for any claim validation. 2. If the buyer has discarded the original container, wrapper, or tamper-evident seal prior to documenting the defect, agents must deny the claim under policy code `GROC-PKG-09`.

4.8.5 Restocking Fees 1. As grocery items are non-returnable and non-restockable for health and safety reasons, the standard Kartway restocking fee schedule does not apply. 2. Agents shall apply a flat $0.00 restocking fee to all resolved grocery dispute claims, as physical inventory recovery is legally and operationally prohibited.

4.8.6 Hazardous and Perishable Handling Rules 1. Perishable goods (including dairy, fresh produce, frozen items, and chilled meats) that are reported as spoiled or delivered outside safe temperature thresholds must be immediately marked for disposal by the customer. Agents must instruct buyers to discard the goods locally; under no circumstances should biological or perishable waste enter the postal return stream. 2. Grocery items containing pressurized aerosols (e.g., whipped cream chargers) or high-concentration alcohol extracts are classified under hazardous materials sub-tier H-7. If damaged in transit, these must be handled in accordance with regional environmental disposal guidelines; agents must issue an immediate automated refund without requesting physical transit of the hazardous material.

4.8.7 Warranty Period 1. In accordance with consumable goods standards, the manufacturer and marketplace warranty period for all grocery items is 0 days from the date of delivery. 2. Post-delivery spoilage resulting from improper domestic storage, refrigeration failure, or normal environmental degradation after the initial 14-hour reporting window is explicitly excluded from Kartway Buyer Protection coverage.